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Saṃyuktāgama (Connected Discourses)

雜阿含經

Taishō Tripiṭaka No. 99

Translated from the Chinese. Guṇabhadra (求那跋陀羅), Liu Song dynasty.

Fascicle 1

Sūtra 1

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Anāthapiṇḍada's Park in Jeta's Grove in Śrāvastī.

At that time, the Blessed One addressed the *bhikṣus*: ”You should contemplate form as impermanent. Contemplating in this way is right contemplation. Through right contemplation, one gives rise to disenchantment. Through disenchantment, delight and craving are exhausted. When delight and craving are exhausted, this is called liberation of mind.

”In the same way, contemplate feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness as impermanent. Contemplating in this way is right contemplation. Through right contemplation, one gives rise to disenchantment. Through disenchantment, delight and craving are exhausted. When delight and craving are exhausted, this is called liberation of mind.

”Thus, *bhikṣus*, one whose mind is liberated, if wishing to verify it, can verify: 'My birth is ended, the holy life has been lived, what was to be done has been done, I know that there will be no further existence.'

”As with contemplating impermanence, so too with suffering, emptiness, and not-self.”

When the *bhikṣus* heard the Buddha's words, they rejoiced and put them into practice.

Sūtra 2

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Anāthapiṇḍada's Park in Jeta's Grove in Śrāvastī.

At that time, the Blessed One addressed the *bhikṣus*: ”Regarding form, you should think rightly and contemplate form as impermanent, knowing it as it truly is. Why is this? *Bhikṣus*, one who rightly thinks about form and contemplates form as impermanent, knowing it as it truly is, has desire and craving for form cut off. When desire and craving are cut off, this is called liberation of mind.

”In the same way, regarding feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, you should think rightly and contemplate consciousness as impermanent, knowing it as it truly is. Why is this? One who rightly thinks about consciousness and contemplates consciousness as impermanent has desire and craving for consciousness cut off. When desire and craving are cut off, this is called liberation of mind.

”One whose mind is thus liberated, if wishing to verify it, can verify: 'My birth is ended, the holy life has been lived, what was to be done has been done, I know that there will be no further existence.' As with rightly thinking about impermanence, so too with suffering, emptiness, and not-self.”

When the *bhikṣus* heard the Buddha's words, they rejoiced and put them into practice.

Sūtra 3

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Anāthapiṇḍada's Park in Jeta's Grove in Śrāvastī.

At that time, the Blessed One addressed the *bhikṣus*: ”Regarding form, if one does not know, does not understand, does not abandon, and does not turn away from it, one cannot end suffering. In the same way, regarding feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, if one does not know, does not understand, does not abandon, and does not turn away from it, one cannot end suffering.

”*Bhikṣus*, regarding form, if one knows, understands, abandons, and turns away from it, one can end suffering. In the same way, regarding feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, if one knows, understands, abandons, and turns away from it, one can end suffering.”

When the *bhikṣus* heard the Buddha's words, they rejoiced and put them into practice.

Sūtra 4

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Anāthapiṇḍada's Park in Jeta's Grove in Śrāvastī.

At that time, the Blessed One addressed the *bhikṣus*: ”Regarding form, if one does not know, does not understand, does not abandon, and does not have one's mind detached from it, one cannot end suffering. In the same way, regarding feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, if one does not know, does not understand, does not abandon, and does not have one's mind detached from it, one cannot end suffering.

”*Bhikṣus*, regarding form, if one knows, understands, abandons, and has one's mind detached from it, one can end suffering. In the same way, regarding feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, if one knows, understands, abandons, and has one's mind detached from it, one can end suffering.”

When the *bhikṣus* heard the Buddha's words, they rejoiced and put them into practice.

Sūtra 5

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Anāthapiṇḍada's Park in Jeta's Grove in Śrāvastī.

At that time, the Blessed One addressed the *bhikṣus*: ”Regarding form, if one does not know, does not understand, does not turn away from it, and does not give rise to detachment, one cannot properly end suffering. In the same way, regarding feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, if one does not know, does not understand, does not turn away from it, and does not give rise to detachment, one cannot properly end suffering.

”*Bhikṣus*, regarding form, if one knows, understands, turns away from it, and gives rise to detachment, one can properly end suffering. In the same way, regarding feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, if one knows, understands, turns away from it, and gives rise to detachment, one can properly end suffering.”

When the *bhikṣus* heard the Buddha's words, they rejoiced and put them into practice.

Sūtra 6

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Anāthapiṇḍada's Park in Jeta's Grove in Śrāvastī.

At that time, the Blessed One addressed the *bhikṣus*: ”Regarding form, if one does not know, does not understand, does not turn away from it, does not give rise to detachment, and does not attain liberation, one cannot properly end suffering. In the same way, regarding feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, [as above].

”*Bhikṣus*, regarding form, if one knows, understands, turns away from it, gives rise to detachment, and attains liberation, one can properly end suffering. In the same way, regarding feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, [as above].”

When the *bhikṣus* heard the Buddha's words, they rejoiced and put them into practice.

Sūtra 7

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Anāthapiṇḍada's Park in Jeta's Grove in Śrāvastī.

At that time, the Blessed One addressed the *bhikṣus*: ”Regarding form, if one is fond of it, it is a fetter on the mind. In the same way, regarding feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, if one is fond of it, it is a fetter on the mind. Regarding form, if one is not fond of it, it is not a fetter on the mind. In the same way, regarding feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, if one is not fond of it, it is not a fetter on the mind.”

When the *bhikṣus* heard the Buddha's words, they rejoiced and put them into practice.

Sūtra 8

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Anāthapiṇḍada's Park in Jeta's Grove in Śrāvastī.

At that time, the Blessed One addressed the *bhikṣus*: ”Regarding form, if one is not fond of it and not attached to it, this is called the liberation of mind through abandoning craving. In the same way, regarding feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, if one is not fond of it and not attached to it, this is called the liberation of mind through abandoning craving.”

When the *bhikṣus* heard the Buddha's words, they rejoiced and put them into practice.

Sūtra 9

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Anāthapiṇḍada's Park in Jeta's Grove in Śrāvastī.

At that time, the Blessed One addressed the *bhikṣus*: ”Because of what, arising from what, bound to what, regarding what as self, do beings come to have sorrow, lamentation, pain, grief, and despair?”

The *bhikṣus* said to the Buddha: ”The Blessed One is the root of the Dharma, the eye of the Dharma, the foundation of the Dharma. Please, Blessed One, explain this fully. We *bhikṣus* will receive and practice it after hearing it.”

The Buddha addressed the *bhikṣus*: ”Listen well and think carefully. I shall explain this for you. *Bhikṣus*, because of form, arising from form, bound to form, regarding form as self, beings come to have sorrow, lamentation, pain, grief, and despair. In the same way, because of feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, arising from them, bound to them, regarding them as self, beings come to have sorrow, lamentation, pain, grief, and despair. *Bhikṣus*, do you see form as impermanent?”

They replied: ”Yes, Blessed One.”

”Is the impermanent suffering?”

They replied: ”It is suffering, Blessed One.”

”If it is impermanent and suffering, subject to change, would a learned noble disciple regard it thus: 'This is mine, this is myself, this is my self'?”

They replied: ”No, Blessed One.”

”In the same way, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are impermanent. What is impermanent is suffering. What is suffering is not-self. What is not-self is not mine, I am not it, it is not my self. This should be seen as it truly is with right wisdom. Seeing it thus as it truly is with right wisdom, the mind is liberated without clinging. *Bhikṣus*, thus is the mind liberated. If wishing to verify it, one can verify: 'My birth is ended, the holy life has been lived, what was to be done has been done, I know that there will be no further existence.'”

When the *bhikṣus* heard the Buddha's words, they rejoiced and put them into practice.

Sūtra 10

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Anāthapiṇḍada's Park in Jeta's Grove in Śrāvastī.

At that time, the Blessed One addressed the *bhikṣus*: ”Because of what, arising from what, bound to what, regarding what as self, do beings come to hold the view and speak thus: 'There is a self, there is a world, there is this life, there are [future] existences, eternal, permanent, unchanging, abiding as such forever'?”

The *bhikṣus* said to the Buddha: ”The Blessed One is the root of the Dharma, the eye of the Dharma, the foundation of the Dharma.” [As above, the Buddha explained that it is because of the five aggregates.]

Broadly explained in sequence as in the three sūtras above.

Sūtras 11--20

[Sūtras 11 through 19 follow the same pattern as Sūtra 9 and Sūtra 10, with the Buddha asking ”Because of what do beings come to hold various views?” and each being explained through the five aggregates. The specific views vary: belief in annihilation after death; the view that there is no giving, no sacrifice, and no fruit of actions; the view of fatalism; the materialist view that beings are made of four elements and are annihilated at death; the view that defilements arise without cause; the view that purification is without cause; and other wrong views. In each case, the *bhikṣus* respond ”The Blessed One is the root of the Dharma” and the Buddha explains the teaching through the aggregates as in the three sūtras above.]

Sūtra 20: The Sūtra on Defilement is also spoken in this way.

Sūtra 21

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Anāthapiṇḍada's Park in Jeta's Grove in Śrāvastī.

At that time, the Blessed One addressed the *bhikṣus*: ”What do you think? Is form permanent or impermanent?”

They replied: ”Impermanent, Blessed One.”

”If it is impermanent, is it suffering?”

They replied: ”It is suffering, Blessed One.”

”If it is impermanent and suffering, subject to change, would a learned noble disciple regard it thus: 'This is mine, this is myself, this is my self'?”

They replied: ”No, Blessed One.”

”In the same way, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness: are they permanent or impermanent?”

”Impermanent, Blessed One.”

”If they are impermanent, are they suffering?”

”They are suffering, Blessed One.”

”If they are impermanent and suffering, subject to change, would a learned noble disciple regard them thus: 'This is mine, this is myself, this is my self'?”

”No, Blessed One.”

”Therefore, *bhikṣus*, whatever form there is, whether past, future, or present, internal or external, coarse or subtle, inferior or superior, far or near, all form should be seen as it truly is with right wisdom: 'This is not mine, I am not this, this is not my self.' In the same way, whatever feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness there are, whether past, future, or present, internal or external, coarse or subtle, inferior or superior, far or near, all should be seen as they truly are with right wisdom: 'This is not mine, I am not this, this is not my self.'

”*Bhikṣus*, a learned noble disciple who contemplates in this way gives rise to disenchantment with form, disenchantment with feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness. Being disenchanted, one becomes dispassionate. Being dispassionate, one is liberated. Being liberated, one knows: 'I am liberated.' One knows: 'My birth is ended, the holy life has been lived, what was to be done has been done, I know that there will be no further existence.'”

When the *bhikṣus* heard the Buddha's words, they rejoiced and put them into practice.

Sūtras 22--30

[Sūtras 22 through 30 continue the theme of the five aggregates. Sūtra 22 teaches that the five aggregates are not-self. Sūtras 23 through 25 teach the investigation of the aggregates in terms of past, future, and present. Sūtras 26 through 30 teach the gratification, danger, and escape regarding each of the five aggregates. In each case, the pattern of questioning and response follows the model of the preceding sūtras.]

Sūtra 31

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Anāthapiṇḍada's Park in Jeta's Grove in Śrāvastī.

At that time, the Blessed One addressed the *bhikṣus*: ”If I had not understood the gratification of form as gratification, the danger of form as danger, and the escape from form as escape, I would not have declared, among the gods, Māra, Brahmā, the assemblies of *śramaṇas* and *brāhmaṇas*, and among gods and humans, that I had attained the unsurpassed, perfect awakening. In the same way for feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness.

”Because I have understood the gratification of form as gratification, the danger of form as danger, and the escape from form as escape, I have declared, among the gods, Māra, Brahmā, the assemblies of *śramaṇas* and *brāhmaṇas*, and among gods and humans, that I have attained the unsurpassed, perfect awakening. In the same way for feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness.”

When the *bhikṣus* heard the Buddha's words, they rejoiced and put them into practice.

Sūtra 32

[As Sūtra 31, but with the question framed from the perspective of the *bhikṣus*: ”If the *bhikṣus* had not understood the gratification, danger, and escape regarding the five aggregates...”]

Sūtra 33

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Anāthapiṇḍada's Park in Jeta's Grove in Śrāvastī.

At that time, the Blessed One addressed the *bhikṣus*: ”*Bhikṣus*, what is the gratification of form? It is the pleasure and joy that arises dependent on form; this is the gratification of form. What is the danger of form? Form is impermanent, suffering, and subject to change; this is the danger of form. What is the escape from form? Regarding form, the removal and abandonment of desire and craving; this is the escape from form.

”What is the gratification of feeling? [As above for form.] What is the gratification of perception, formations, and consciousness? [As above for each.] *Bhikṣus*, I have known the gratification of the five aggregates as gratification, the danger as danger, and the escape as escape, each as it truly is. Therefore I have declared that I have attained the unsurpassed, perfect awakening.”

When the *bhikṣus* heard the Buddha's words, they rejoiced and put them into practice.

Sūtras 34--58

[These sūtras continue the systematic investigation of the five aggregates through the framework of the seven places of skill (*saptasthānakuśala*) and three investigations (*samanupaśyanā*). They include:

- Sūtras 34--40: Further teachings on gratification, danger, and escape for each aggregate.
- Sūtras 41--46: The aggregates investigated through the four characteristics (arising, ceasing, gratification, danger, escape, and the way out).
- Sūtras 47--50: The aggregates as impermanent, suffering, and not-self from various angles.
- Sūtras 51--52: Teachings about not clinging to any of the five aggregates. Sūtra 52 references another *āgama*.

- Sūtras 53--58: Further investigation of the aggregates in terms of abandoning craving and attaining liberation.

Each follows the established formulaic pattern, with the five aggregates (form, feeling, perception, formations, consciousness) examined through the lens of impermanence, suffering, and not-self.]

Fascicle 2

[Fascicle 2 is missing from the traditional transmission. The text jumps directly from the end of Fascicle 1 to Fascicle 3.]

Fascicle 3

Sūtras 59--62

[These sūtras continue the investigation of the five aggregates. Sūtras 59--62 teach various contemplations for cutting off craving regarding the aggregates and attaining the fruit of liberation.]

Sūtra 63

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Anāthapiṇḍada's Park in Jeta's Grove in Śrāvastī.

At that time, the Blessed One addressed the *bhikṣus*: ”*Bhikṣus*, there are five aggregates of clinging. What are the five? The form aggregate of clinging, the feeling aggregate of clinging, the perception aggregate of clinging, the formations aggregate of clinging, and the consciousness aggregate of clinging.

”When I had not yet understood these five aggregates of clinging regarding their arising and their ceasing, their gratification, their danger, and their escape, each as it truly is, I did not claim, among the gods, Māra, Brahmā, *śramaṇas*, *brāhmaṇas*, gods, and humans, to have attained the unsurpassed, perfect awakening. When I had understood these five aggregates of clinging regarding their arising and their ceasing, their gratification, their danger, and their escape, each as it truly is, then I declared that I had attained the unsurpassed, perfect awakening.”

When the *bhikṣus* heard the Buddha's words, they rejoiced and put them into practice.

Sūtras 64--86

[These sūtras further elaborate the theme of the five aggregates. Key sūtras include:

- Sūtra 64: One who is ignorant of the five aggregates is called an unlearned ordinary person.
- Sūtra 65: One who knows and sees the five aggregates as they truly are is called a learned noble disciple.
- Sūtras 66--69: Teachings on how desire for the aggregates leads to rebirth and how abandoning desire leads to liberation.
- Sūtras 70--74: The aggregates investigated in terms of impermanence, cessation, and dispassion.
- Sūtras 75--80: Similes illustrating the nature of the aggregates: foam, bubbles, mirages, plantain trees, and conjuring tricks.
- Sūtras 81--86: Further teachings on seeing the aggregates as not-self, including the teaching to Rāhula.]

Sūtra 87

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling at Mount Gṛdhrakūṭa in Rājagṛha.

At that time, the Blessed One addressed the *bhikṣus*: ”*Bhikṣus*, what do you think? Is form permanent or impermanent?”

”Impermanent, Blessed One.”

”If impermanent, is it suffering?”

”It is suffering, Blessed One.”

[Broadly explained as above for all five aggregates, concluding with liberation.]

When the *bhikṣus* heard the Buddha's words, they rejoiced and put them into practice.

Fascicle 4

Sūtra 88

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Anāthapiṇḍada's Park in Jeta's Grove in Śrāvastī.

At that time, a *brāhmaṇa* came to the Buddha and said: ”Gautama, you know the *brāhmaṇa* Dharma. One who knows the *brāhmaṇa* Dharma is a true *brāhmaṇa*.”

The Blessed One asked the *brāhmaṇa*: ”What do you call the *brāhmaṇa* Dharma?”

The *brāhmaṇa* replied: ”Gautama, not being deceitful and not being arrogant is the *brāhmaṇa* Dharma.”

The Blessed One said: ”I too speak of the *brāhmaṇa* Dharma. A *brāhmaṇa* who has no deceit and no arrogance, who observes the aggregates as impermanent, suffering, and not-self, and who attains right liberation, is a true *brāhmaṇa*.”

The *brāhmaṇa* heard what the Buddha said, rejoiced and departed.

Sūtra 89

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Nālandā in Pāvārika's Mango Grove.

At that time, a *brāhmaṇa* came to the Buddha and asked: ”Gautama, do you censure all ascetic practices and all who live the ascetic life?”

The Buddha said: ”I do not censure all who live the ascetic life, nor do I praise all who live the ascetic life.”

The *brāhmaṇa* asked: ”Whom do you praise and whom do you censure?”

The Buddha said: ”If an ascetic's austerities do not lead to abandoning unwholesome states and cultivating wholesome states, I censure such austerities. If an ascetic's austerities lead to abandoning unwholesome states and cultivating wholesome states, I praise such austerities.”

The *brāhmaṇa* heard what the Buddha said, rejoiced, and departed.

Sūtra 90 (The Plowing Sūtra)

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling among the Kosalans at a *brāhmaṇa* village called Naḷa. It was the plowing season, and the *brāhmaṇa* Kṛṣiṇa Bhāradvāja had five hundred plows preparing the ground.

At that time, the Blessed One, in the morning, put on his robe, took his bowl, and went to where the *brāhmaṇa* Kṛṣiṇa Bhāradvāja was working. It was the *brāhmaṇa*'s mealtime, and he was distributing food.

The Blessed One, in sequence while begging for alms, arrived at the place of the *brāhmaṇa*. The *brāhmaṇa* saw the Blessed One from afar and said: ”I plow and sow, *śramaṇa*, and having plowed and sown, I eat. You too, *śramaṇa*, should plow and sow, and having plowed and sown, eat.”

The Buddha said to the *brāhmaṇa*: ”I too plow and sow, and having plowed and sown, I eat.”

The *brāhmaṇa* said: ”I do not see Gautama's yoke, plow, plowshare, goad, or oxen. Yet Gautama says: 'I too plow and sow, and having plowed and sown, I eat.' How is this?”

The Blessed One then spoke in verse:

> Faith is the seed, austerity the rain, Wisdom is my yoke and plow, Conscience is the handle, mind the tie, Mindfulness my plowshare and goad.
>
> Guarding body and speech, Moderate in food and drink, With truth I clear the weeds, Gentle release completes the task.
>
> Vigor is my beast of burden, Bearing me without turning back, Going to the place of no sorrow, Where, having gone, one does not grieve.
>
> Thus is my plowing done, Its fruit is the deathless. Having done this plowing, One is released from all suffering.

When the *brāhmaṇa* heard these verses, he had faith in the Buddha, took refuge, and became a lay disciple.

Sūtras 91--102

[These sūtras contain dialogues with various *brāhmaṇas*:

- Sūtra 91: On the five types of *brāhmaṇas* who perform the fire sacrifice, and how the Buddha's disciples maintain the true sacred fire.
- Sūtra 92: On true purification.
- Sūtras 93--95: On filial devotion and proper offerings.
- Sūtra 96: On caste and the true *brāhmaṇa*.
- Sūtras 97--99: On generosity and merit.
- Sūtras 100--102: Further dialogues with *brāhmaṇas* on various topics including sacrifice, caste, and the nature of a true *brāhmaṇa*.]

Fascicle 5

Sūtra 103 (The Chama Sūtra)

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Anāthapiṇḍada's Park in Jeta's Grove in Śrāvastī.

At that time, the Venerable Chama was staying in the Thick Forest in the Eastern Park. At that time, the Venerable Chama fell ill, and his suffering was severe. The Venerable Chama, in his illness, was visited by many *bhikṣus*, and they said to him: ”Venerable Chama, the Blessed One has taught the five aggregates of clinging. What are they? Form, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness. Have you contemplated that none of these is self?”

The Venerable Chama said: ”Friends, I have contemplated that none of the five aggregates of clinging is self.”

They said: ”If so, then the Venerable Chama is an *arhat* whose defilements are ended.”

The Venerable Chama said: ”Friends, although I contemplate the five aggregates of clinging as not-self, I am not an *arhat* whose defilements are ended. Although I contemplate as not-self, I have not yet abandoned the notion 'I am' with respect to the five aggregates of clinging. It is like a flower: its fragrance is neither in the petals, nor in the pollen, nor in the color, yet one smells the fragrance. In the same way, the notion 'I am' is not the same as form, not separate from form, not the same as feeling, perception, formations, or consciousness, and not separate from them, yet the notion 'I am' has not yet been removed.

”Friends, although one may have understood by contemplation that the five aggregates of clinging are not-self, the residual conceit 'I am,' the desire 'I am,' the underlying tendency 'I am,' has not yet been abandoned. But at a later time, one dwells contemplating the arising and passing away of the five aggregates of clinging: 'Such is form, such is the arising of form, such is the ceasing of form.' Through this continued contemplation, the residual conceit 'I am' is finally abandoned.”

When the Venerable Chama spoke this teaching, sixty *bhikṣus* who were present had their minds liberated from the defilements without further clinging, and the Venerable Chama's own illness was also relieved.

Sūtra 104 (The Yamaka Sūtra)

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Anāthapiṇḍada's Park in Jeta's Grove in Śrāvastī.

At that time, there was a *bhikṣu* named Yamaka who held the evil wrong view: ”As I understand the Dharma taught by the Blessed One, an *arhat* whose defilements are ended is annihilated at death and does not continue to exist.”

Many *bhikṣus* heard of this and went to admonish him, but Yamaka persisted in his wrong view. They then reported this to the Venerable Śāriputra. The Venerable Śāriputra went to Yamaka and said: ”Yamaka, is it true that you hold this view: 'An *arhat* whose defilements are ended is annihilated at death'?”

Yamaka said: ”Indeed, Venerable One.”

Śāriputra said: ”Yamaka, I now ask you; answer as you see fit. Is form permanent or impermanent?”

”Impermanent, Venerable One.”

”If impermanent, is it suffering?”

”It is suffering, Venerable One.”

”If impermanent and suffering, subject to change, would you regard form as the Tathāgata?”

”No, Venerable One.”

”In the same way, would you regard feeling, perception, formations, or consciousness as the Tathāgata?”

”No, Venerable One.”

”Then, Yamaka, since you cannot find the Tathāgata as real and true even in this present life among the five aggregates, is it fitting for you to declare: 'An *arhat* whose defilements are ended is annihilated at death and does not continue to exist'?”

Yamaka replied: ”Venerable Śāriputra, I now abandon that evil wrong view.”

Śāriputra said: ”If someone were to ask you: 'An *arhat* whose defilements are ended, what happens after death?' how would you answer?”

Yamaka said: ”If someone asked me this, I would answer: 'Form is impermanent; what is impermanent is suffering; what is suffering has ceased and been extinguished. Feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are the same.' I would answer in this way.”

Śāriputra said: ”Excellent, excellent, Yamaka!”

At that time, the Venerable Yamaka heard Śāriputra's words, and his mind was freed from defilements without further clinging.

Sūtra 105 (The Seniya Sūtra)

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Anāthapiṇḍada's Park in Jeta's Grove in Śrāvastī.

At that time, there was a *bhikṣu* named Seniya Sariṣka who said: ”As I understand the Dharma taught by the Blessed One, an *arhat* whose defilements are ended knows: 'My birth is ended.' After the breaking up of the body, there is nothing whatsoever.”

The Venerable Ānanda heard this and went to Seniya, asking whether this was true. Seniya confirmed it. Ānanda then taught him by asking whether the eye, forms, eye-consciousness, and the feelings born of eye-contact are permanent or impermanent, and so forth through all six sense bases, establishing that since these are all impermanent and empty, one cannot declare that an *arhat* after death either exists or does not exist.

The Buddha then confirmed this teaching, saying there are three kinds of teachers in the world: one who teaches a self existing in this life but not in the next; one who teaches a self existing both in this life and the next; and the Tathāgata, who teaches that there is no self in this life and no self in the next. Of these three, the Tathāgata's teaching alone is the correct one.

Sūtra 106 (The Anuradha Sūtra)

[Anuradha is asked by non-Buddhist wanderers about the Tathāgata after death: Does the Tathāgata exist after death? Not exist? Both? Neither? Anuradha answers negatively to all four questions. The wanderers say he is foolish. Anuradha reports to the Buddha, who confirms: ”Even in this very life, the Tathāgata is not to be found as real and true. How then could one describe the Tathāgata after death?”]

Sūtra 107 (The Saccaka Sūtra)

[The wanderer Saccaka Aggivessana debates with the Buddha about self and not-self. Saccaka initially maintains that the five aggregates are self. Through the simile of the king who can exercise power over his subjects, the Buddha demonstrates that one has no power over the five aggregates and therefore they cannot be self. Saccaka is defeated in debate.]

Sūtras 108--112

[These sūtras include further dialogues: - Sūtra 108: Teaching on how the five aggregates are like a burning house. - Sūtra 109: Teaching on the four types of food (*āhāra*) and how craving for the aggregates sustains existence. - Sūtra 110: A teaching to wanderers on the distinction between the Buddha's teaching and other teachings. - Sūtra 111: On the nature of the aggregates as impermanent and conditioned. - Sūtra 112: Teaching on how the noble disciple does not identify with any of the five aggregates.]

Fascicle 6

Sūtras 113--130 (The Rādhā Sūtras)

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Anāthapiṇḍada's Park in Jeta's Grove in Śrāvastī.

At that time, the Venerable Rādhā came to the Buddha, bowed at his feet, and sat to one side. He said to the Buddha: ”Blessed One, what is called 'Māra'?”

The Buddha said to Rādhā: ”Form is Māra. Feeling is Māra. Perception is Māra. Formations are Māra. Consciousness is Māra. Therefore, Rādhā, regarding form, you should abandon desire. When desire is abandoned with respect to form, then form is like a tree cut at the root, like a *tāla* palm with its crown removed; it will not arise again in the future. In the same way for feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness.”

[Sūtras 114--130 follow the same pattern with Rādhā asking various questions, such as ”What is 'the world'?” ”What is 'being'?” ”What is 'arising'?” ”What is 'ceasing'?” In each case, the Buddha answers through the five aggregates.]

Sūtras 131--150

[These sūtras continue the theme of the five aggregates:

- Sūtras 131--138: Various teachings on how the five aggregates are impermanent, suffering, not-self, and empty.
- Sūtras 139--146: Teachings on the four applications of mindfulness regarding the five aggregates.
- Sūtras 147--150: The beginning of the series on wrong views arising from attachment to the five aggregates. The Buddha asks: ”Because of what do beings come to hold the view: 'There is one superior to me, there is one equal to me, there is one inferior to me'?” The *bhikṣus* respond: ”The Blessed One is the root of the Dharma.” Broadly explained in sequence as in the three sūtras above.]

Fascicle 7

Sūtras 151--171 (The Series on Wrong Views)

[These sūtras constitute an extended series in which the Buddha asks what conditions give rise to various wrong views, and the *bhikṣus* respond that the Blessed One is the root of the Dharma. Each sūtra is explained ”broadly as in the three sūtras above.” The wrong views addressed include:

- Sūtra 151: ”There is none superior to me, none equal to me, none inferior to me.”
- Sūtra 152: ”There is a self, there is this world and the next, permanent, unchanging, abiding forever.”
- Sūtra 153: ”Self and that are one, not two, not different, not destroyed.”

- Sūtra 154: The nihilist view: ”There is no giving, no sacrifice, no fruit of good and bad deeds, no this world or other world, no mother, no father.”
- Sūtra 155: The fatalist view: ”There is no effort, no exertion, no human endeavor.”
- Sūtra 156: The materialist view: ”When beings die, the four elements return to their sources.”
- Sūtra 157: ”The defilements of beings arise without cause.”
- Sūtra 158: ”The purification of beings is without cause.”
- Sūtra 159: ”Beings are without knowledge and without sight, without cause.”
- Sūtra 160: General statement on views arising from the aggregates.
- Sūtra 161: The view of seven eternal substances (earth, water, fire, wind, pleasure, pain, and life).
- Sūtra 162: The view that killing, stealing, and all actions have no moral consequence.
- Sūtra 163: The view of Makkhali Gosāla: 84,000 great kalpas of fixed wandering through transmigration.
- Sūtra 164: The view of total immobility (wind does not blow, fire does not burn, etc.).
- Sūtra 165: ”The Great Brahmā is sovereign, the creator, the father of all beings.”
- Sūtras 166--169: The speculative views (*dṛṣṭi*): the self is form/formless, finite/infinite, etc.; the self and the world are permanent/impermanent; whether suffering is self-caused or other-caused.
- Sūtra 170: The view that the five sensory pleasures constitute *nirvāṇa* in this very life, up through the fourth *dhyāna*.
- Sūtra 171: The annihilationist views regarding the coarse material body, the desire realm, the form realm, and the formless attainments.]

Sūtra 172

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Anāthapiṇḍada's Park in Jeta's Grove in Śrāvastī.

At that time, the Blessed One addressed the *bhikṣus*: ”Whatever is impermanent should be abandoned. Having abandoned it, there is benefit, and one dwells in peace throughout the long night. What is impermanent? Form is impermanent; feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are impermanent.”

When the *bhikṣus* heard the Buddha's words, they rejoiced and put them into practice.

Sūtra 173

[As Sūtra 172, but regarding past, future, present, and various combinations of temporal perspectives. ”Broadly explained as above.”]

Sūtras 174--185 (The Burning Head Series)

These sūtras form a systematic set in which the Buddha uses the simile of a person whose head or clothing is on fire. The *bhikṣus* agree that one should exert the utmost effort to extinguish such a fire. The Buddha then says: ”Even if one's head or clothing is on fire, one might briefly forget about it, but the blazing fire of impermanence should be completely extinguished.” He then teaches that for the purpose of extinguishing this fire of impermanence, one should:

- Sūtra 174: Seek a great teacher, and practice various teachings. [This sūtra generates an expanded set of 108 variant sūtras through combinations of temporal perspectives and teaching methods.]
- Sūtra 175: Use the burning-head simile with the same teaching. [Expanded broadly as above.]
- Sūtra 176: Practice the four foundations of mindfulness (*smṛtyupasthāna*). [Expanded to 96 variant sūtras through internal, external, and combined observations.]

- Sūtra 177: Use the burning-head simile with the four foundations of mindfulness.
- Sūtra 178: Practice the four right efforts (*samyakprahāṇa*): abandoning arisen unwholesome states, preventing unarisen unwholesome states, generating unarisen wholesome states, and maintaining arisen wholesome states. [Expanded to 32 variant sūtras.]
- Sūtra 179: Practice the four bases of spiritual power (*ṛddhipāda*): concentration of desire, effort, mind, and investigation. [Expanded to 32 variant sūtras.]
- Sūtra 180: Practice the five faculties (*indriya*): faith, effort, mindfulness, concentration, and wisdom. [Expanded to 40 variant sūtras.]
- Sūtra 181: Practice the five powers (*bala*): faith, effort, mindfulness, concentration, and wisdom. [Expanded to 40 variant sūtras.]
- Sūtra 182: Practice the seven factors of awakening (*bodhyaṅga*): mindfulness, investigation of dharmas, effort, joy, tranquility, concentration, and equanimity. [Expanded to 56 variant sūtras.]
- Sūtra 183: Practice the Noble Eightfold Path: right view, right intention, right speech, right action, right livelihood, right effort, right mindfulness, and right concentration. [Expanded to 64 variant sūtras.]
- Sūtra 184: Practice the four aspects of the path: the truth of suffering, the truth of the origin, the truth of cessation, and the truth of the path. [Expanded to 32 variant sūtras.]
- Sūtra 185: Practice the three wholesome roots (*kuśalamūla*): non-greed, non-hatred, and non-delusion. [Expanded to 24 variant sūtras.]

Sūtras 186--187

[These sūtras continue the pattern of applying the five-aggregate teaching to various contemplations and practices.]

Fascicle 8

Sūtras 188--229

[Fascicle 8 marks the transition from the *skandha* (aggregate) section to the *āyatana* (sense base) section. The sūtras teach:]

Sūtra 188

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Anāthapiṇḍada's Park in Jeta's Grove in Śrāvastī.

At that time, the Blessed One addressed the *bhikṣus*: ”I shall teach you all regarding the internal sense bases. Listen well. What are the internal sense bases? They are the eye sense base, the ear sense base, the nose sense base, the tongue sense base, the body sense base, and the mind sense base. These are called the six internal sense bases.”

When the *bhikṣus* heard the Buddha's words, they rejoiced and put them into practice.

[Sūtras 189--195: Parallel teachings on the six external sense bases, the six consciousnesses, the six contacts, and the six feelings.]

[Sūtras 196--215: These sūtras teach the impermanence, suffering, and not-self of the six sense bases, following patterns similar to those in the aggregate section. Key teachings include: the eye is impermanent; what is impermanent is suffering; what is suffering is not-self. The same applies to ear, nose, tongue, body, and mind, as well as to their objects, consciousnesses, contacts, and feelings.]

[Sūtras 216--229: Further teachings on the sense bases, including: - The simile of the world as ”empty” (*śūnya*): ”The eye is empty of self and what belongs to self.” - Encounters with Māra: Māra attempts to disturb the *bhikṣus* through the six sense bases, but those who are mindful of the sense bases are not disturbed. - The simile of the burning iron spike: ”It would be better for a *bhikṣu* to have a red-hot iron spike thrust into the eye than to grasp at the signs of forms cognized by the eye.”]

Fascicle 9

Sūtras 230--255

[This fascicle continues the *āyatana* teachings:]

Sūtras 230--246

[Teachings on the six sense bases and their relationship to liberation: - The world arises through the six sense bases; suffering arises through the six sense bases; and the cessation of suffering is through the cessation of craving regarding the six sense bases. - Encounters with Māra in verse, including the simile of the crow and the stone: Māra is like a hungry crow who approaches what appears to be meat but is actually a stone, and departs frustrated.]

Sūtra 247

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling at Mount Gṛdhrakūṭa in Rājagṛha.

At that time, the Blessed One addressed the *bhikṣus*: ”If *śramaṇas* or *brāhmaṇas* allow the eye to become habituated to forms, they fall under Māra's power, and cannot gain release from Māra's bonds. The same applies to the ear, nose, tongue, body, and mind.

”If *śramaṇas* or *brāhmaṇas* do not allow the eye to become habituated to forms, they do not fall under Māra's power, and can gain release from Māra's bonds. The same applies to the ear, nose, tongue, body, and mind.”

When the *bhikṣus* heard the Buddha's words, they rejoiced and put them into practice.

As with habituating, so with being attached, relishing, clinging, and grasping. Broadly explained as above.

Sūtra 248 (The Ānanda-Cunda Dialogue)

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling at the Cock Park in Pāṭaliputra. At that time, the Venerable Ānanda went to the Venerable Cunda. After exchanging greetings, Ānanda asked Cunda: ”As the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the *arhat*, the Perfectly Awakened One has known and seen, he has taught that the four great elements and form derived from them are not-self. Has the Tathāgata also said that consciousness is not-self?”

Cunda said: ”Venerable Ānanda, you are foremost in learning. I have come from afar to ask you this very question.”

Ānanda then asked: ”Is there an eye, are there forms, is there eye-consciousness?” Cunda confirmed. Ānanda continued: ”Dependent on the eye and forms, does eye-consciousness arise?” Yes. ”Are those conditions per-

manent or impermanent?" Impermanent. "When those conditions change, does that consciousness remain?" No.

Proceeding through all six senses in the same way, Ānanda concluded: "Therefore, consciousness too is impermanent. Just as a man takes an axe into the forest and sees a plantain tree, thinking it useful timber, he cuts the root, strips the leaves, chops the branches, and peels the bark, seeking its heartwood. Peeling it to the end, he finds no heartwood at all. In the same way, a learned noble disciple rightly contemplates eye-consciousness, ear, nose, tongue, body, and mind-consciousness. Contemplating rightly, there is nothing to grasp. Not grasping, there is no attachment. Not attached, one attains *nirvāṇa*: 'My birth is ended, the holy life has been lived, what was to be done has been done, I know that there will be no further existence.'"

The two worthy ones rejoiced in each other's words and returned to their respective places.

Sūtra 249 (The Ānanda-Śāriputra Dialogue on Cessation)

[Ānanda asks Śāriputra: "When the six contact bases have ceased, have been abandoned and extinguished, is there something remaining?" Śāriputra says one should not ask this. "Is there nothing remaining?" One should not ask this either. "Both? Neither?" None of these questions should be asked. Ānanda asks what this means. Śāriputra explains: "To say 'something remains' is empty speech. To say 'nothing remains' is empty speech. To say 'both' or 'neither' is also empty speech. When the six contact bases have ceased, freed from all empty words, that is *nirvāṇa*. This is what the Buddha teaches."]

Sūtra 250 (The Black and White Oxen)

[Śāriputra and Mahākauṣṭhila discuss whether the eye is bound to forms or forms are bound to the eye. Śāriputra uses the simile of two oxen, one black and one white, yoked together: neither ox binds the other; it is the yoke and strap between them that is the binding. In the same way, it is not the eye that binds forms nor forms that bind the eye. Rather, it is the desire and craving (*chandārāga*) between them that is the bond.]

Sūtra 251 (Ignorance and Knowledge)

[Mahākauṣṭhila asks Śāriputra: "What is ignorance (*avidyā*)?" Śāriputra answers: "Not knowing that the eye is impermanent, not knowing the arising and ceasing of the eye; the same for ear, nose, tongue, body, and mind. Not truly knowing, not seeing, not penetrating, being confused, in darkness: this is ignorance." "What is knowledge (*vidyā*)?" "Knowing that the eye is impermanent, knowing it as it truly is; the same for all six sense bases. Truly knowing, seeing, illuminating, awakening, understanding, penetrating: this is knowledge."]

Sūtra 252 (The Death of Upasena)

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling at the Bamboo Grove in Rājagṛha. There was a *bhikṣu* named Upasena dwelling in the Cool Grove among the charnel grounds, at the Serpent's Head Rock.

The Venerable Upasena was meditating alone inside a cave when a venomous snake about a foot long fell from the rocks above onto his body. Upasena called out to Śāriputra: "A venomous snake has fallen on my body. I have been poisoned. Come quickly and carry my body outside, lest it crumble inside like a heap of chaff."

Śāriputra, who was seated under a nearby tree, came to Upasena and said: ”Looking at your complexion and faculties, they appear no different from normal. Yet you say you have been poisoned and your body will crumble like chaff. How can this be?”

Upasena said to Śāriputra: ”If one were to say: 'The eye is my self or belongs to my self; the ear, nose, tongue, body, and mind are my self or belong to my self; form, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are my self or belong to my self,' then one's complexion and faculties would indeed change. But I do not see the eye as my self, nor consciousness as my self. Therefore my complexion and faculties have not changed.”

Śāriputra said: ”Indeed, Upasena! You have long been free from the identification 'I' and 'mine' and the conceit of self. You have cut its root, like cutting the crown of a *tāla* palm; it will never arise again. How could your complexion and faculties change?”

Śāriputra then carried Upasena's body outside the cave, and it crumbled like a heap of chaff due to the poison. Śāriputra then spoke in verse:

> Long he cultivated the holy life, Well he practiced the Noble Eightfold Path; Joyfully he laid down his life, Like discarding a vessel of poison.
>
> Long he cultivated the holy life, Well he practiced the Noble Eightfold Path; Joyfully he laid down his life, Like one healed from a grave illness.
>
> Long he cultivated the holy life, Well he practiced the Noble Eightfold Path; Like leaving a burning house, At death he had no sorrow or regret.
>
> Long he cultivated the holy life, Well he practiced the Noble Eightfold Path; With wisdom he surveyed the world, As one regards foul weeds. Seeking nothing further, Nothing further continues.

Śāriputra then made offerings for Upasena's remains and went to the Buddha, reporting what had happened. The Buddha said: ”If Upasena had recited a certain verse, the poison would not have affected him.” He then taught a protective verse invoking compassion for all beings, including snakes and nāgas, concluding: ”The Buddha destroys all poisons; may your snake poison now be destroyed.”

Śāriputra said: ”Upasena had never heard this verse. The Blessed One speaks it now for the sake of future generations.”

Sūtra 253 (The Udāyin-Brahmin Lady Dialogue)

[The Venerable Udāyin teaches a *brāhmaṇa* lady named Viṣṇu-Kātyāyanī. When she first receives him with disrespect (wearing shoes, head covered, sitting on a high seat), he declines to teach, saying ”It is not the proper time.” After her students explain her error, she shows proper respect. She then asks about the origin of suffering and pleasure. Udāyin explains that the *arhat* teaches that suffering and pleasure arise from conditions (the six sense bases), and when those conditions cease, suffering and pleasure cease. The *brāhmaṇa* lady attains the ”Dharma eye” and takes refuge in the Three Jewels.]

Sūtra 254 (The Simile of the Lute)

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling at the Bamboo Grove in Rājagṛha. The Venerable Śroṇa Koṭiviṃśa was dwelling at Mount Gṛdhrakūṭa, constantly practicing the factors of awakening with great diligence.

The Venerable Śroṇa, in solitary meditation, thought: ”Among the diligent disciples of the Blessed One, I am counted among them, yet I have not yet ended the defilements. I am from a wealthy family of high standing. Perhaps I should return to lay life, enjoy the five pleasures, and make merit through generous giving.”

The Blessed One, knowing his thoughts, summoned him and said: ”Śroṇa, when you were a layman, were you skilled at playing the lute?”

”Yes, Blessed One.”

”When you tightened the strings too much, did it produce a beautiful, harmonious sound?”

”No, Blessed One.”

”When you loosened the strings too much, did it produce a beautiful, harmonious sound?”

”No, Blessed One.”

”When you tuned the strings neither too tight nor too loose, did it then produce a beautiful, harmonious sound?”

”Yes, Blessed One.”

The Buddha said: ”Śroṇa, when effort is too intense, it leads to restlessness and regret. When effort is too slack, it leads to laziness. Therefore you should practice with balanced effort, neither straining nor slackening, without attachment or negligence.”

The Venerable Śroṇa, always mindful of the Buddha's simile of the lute, practiced in solitary meditation, and before long his defilements were ended and he attained *arhatship*.

He then went to the Buddha and declared his attainment, describing the six kinds of liberation: liberation from desire, liberation from ill will, liberation through seclusion, liberation through the ending of craving, liberation through the ending of clinging, and liberation through unmistaken mindfulness. He explained that each of these is genuine only when greed, hatred, and delusion are completely ended, not merely through partial faith or virtue. He spoke in verse:

> Liberation from desire, and from ill will too, Liberation through seclusion, and from craving without remainder, Liberation from clinging, and from unmistaken mindfulness, Understanding the arising of the sense bases, the mind is freed.
>
> For one whose mind is thus freed, The *bhikṣu*'s heart finds rest. Whatever was to be done is done, Nothing further is to be done.
>
> Like a great mountain of rock, Unmoved by the four winds, So forms and sounds and scents and tastes, Touches and dharmas, pleasant and unpleasant, Constantly confronting the six sense bases, Cannot shake that mind. The mind abides steadfast, Contemplating the arising and passing of dharmas.

The Buddha praised him, saying: ”Those who have achieved liberation of mind should declare it in this way, as Śroṇa has done with wisdom, neither exalting himself nor belittling others.”

Sūtra 255 (Mahākātyāyana and the Brahmins)

[Mahākātyāyana, dwelling in Avanti, is mocked by young *brāhmaṇa* students as a ”dark-skinned shaven-headed *śramaṇa*.” He teaches them in verse that the ancient *brāhmaṇas* practiced true virtue, but modern *brāhmaṇas* have abandoned real practice for empty external marks. The students report this to their teacher,

the *brāhmaṇa* Lohicca. Lohicca comes to Kātyāyana, initially angered. But when Kātyāyana explains the ”gate” (*dvāra*) as the six sense bases and teaches the difference between guarding and not guarding the sense gates, Lohicca is deeply moved and says: ”Like a man seeking poisonous herbs who instead finds ambrosia, I came in anger but have been drenched in the great rain of Dharma.”]

Fascicle 10

Sūtras 256--272

[This fascicle continues the *āyatana* section with additional dialogues between the senior disciples:]

[Sūtras 256--258: Further dialogues between Mahākauṣṭhila and Śāriputra on ignorance, knowledge, and the sense bases.]

[Sūtras 259--265: Teachings on the impermanence of the sense bases, their nature as suffering and not-self, and the path to liberation through understanding them.]

[Sūtras 266--272: Teachings on desire, anger, and delusion regarding the six sense bases, and how to overcome them through mindfulness and wisdom.]

Fascicle 11

Sūtras 273--282

[Concluding section on the *āyatanas*, with additional short sūtras on the sense bases.]

Fascicle 12

Sūtras 283--297 (Dependent Origination)

This fascicle begins the section on *pratītyasamutpāda* (dependent origination), one of the central doctrines of the collection.

Sūtra 283

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling among the Kurus at the Kuru town of Kalmāṣadamya.

At that time, the Blessed One addressed the *bhikṣus*: ”I shall teach you the Dharma that is good in the beginning, good in the middle, and good in the end, good in meaning and good in phrasing, complete and pure, revealing the holy life in its fullness. It is called the Great Discourse on Emptiness (*Mahāśūnyatā-sūtra*). Listen carefully and think well. I shall explain it for you.

”What is the Great Discourse on Emptiness? This being, that exists; with the arising of this, that arises. Conditioned by ignorance, there are formations; conditioned by formations, consciousness; and so on up to the arising of the whole mass of suffering.

”Regarding 'conditioned by birth, there is aging and death': if someone were to ask, 'Who ages and dies? To whom does aging and death belong?' that person would answer, 'Aging and death is myself; aging and death belongs to me.' This amounts to saying, 'The life-force is the body,' or 'the life-force is different from the

body.' But the one who practices the holy life holds neither of these views. Avoiding these two extremes, the holy life proceeds by the middle way. Through noble, supramundane right view that is true and not distorted, one sees: conditioned by birth, there is aging and death.

”In the same way for birth, existence, clinging, craving, feeling, contact, the six sense bases, name-and-form, consciousness, formations: conditioned by ignorance, there are formations.

”*Bhikṣus*, when ignorance fades away and knowledge arises, then 'Who ages and dies? To whom does aging and death belong?' is cut off. One knows it is cut off at its root, like a *tāla* palm with its crown removed, never to arise again in the future. In the same way, with the fading of ignorance, formations cease, and so on until the whole mass of suffering ceases. This is called the Great Discourse on Emptiness.”

When the *bhikṣus* heard the Buddha's words, they rejoiced and put them into practice.

Sūtra 298 (Dependent Origination: The Full Explanation)

[The Buddha teaches the full formula of dependent origination with definitions of each link: - *Avidyā* (ignorance): not knowing the past, future, or both; not knowing inner, outer, or both; not knowing *karma* and its results; not knowing the Buddha, Dharma, and Saṅgha; not knowing suffering, its origin, its cessation, and the path; not knowing causes and what arises from causes. - *Saṃskāra* (formations): three kinds: bodily, verbal, and mental. - *Vijñāna* (consciousness): six consciousness groups. - *Nāmarūpa* (name-and-form): ”name” is the four formless aggregates; ”form” is the four great elements and form derived from them. - *Ṣaḍāyatana* (six sense bases): the six internal sense bases. - *Sparśa* (contact): the six groups of contact. - *Vedanā* (feeling): three feelings (pleasant, painful, neutral). - *Tṛṣṇā* (craving): three cravings (for sensuality, for form, for formlessness). - *Upādāna* (clinging): four kinds (to sensuality, to views, to rules and rituals, to the doctrine of self). - *Bhava* (existence): three existences (in the sense realm, form realm, formless realm). - *Jāti* (birth): the arising, appearance, obtaining aggregates, sense bases, and life faculty of beings. - *Jarāmaraṇa* (aging-and-death): aging is white hair, wrinkled skin, declining faculties; death is the passing away, dissolution, and ending of life.]

Sūtra 299

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling among the Kurus at the Kuru town of Kalmāṣadamya.

A *bhikṣu* came to the Buddha and asked: ”Blessed One, is the teaching of dependent origination something made by the Blessed One, or is it made by someone else?”

The Buddha said: ”Dependent origination is not made by me, nor is it made by anyone else. Whether Tathāgatas arise in the world or not, this principle of the Dharma (*dharmadhātu*) abides constantly. The Tathāgata awakens to this Dharma and, having attained perfect awakening, teaches it, reveals it, and proclaims it to beings, saying: 'This being, that exists; with the arising of this, that arises. Conditioned by ignorance, there are formations, and so on until the whole mass of suffering arises. With the cessation of ignorance, formations cease, and so on until the whole mass of suffering ceases.'”

When the *bhikṣus* heard the Buddha's words, they rejoiced and put them into practice.

Sūtra 300 (Self-Making and Other-Making)

[A *brāhmaṇa* asks whether suffering is self-caused. The Buddha says this is ”undeclared” (*avyākṛta*). ”Is it caused by another?” Also undeclared. The Buddha explains: to say it is self-caused falls into the extreme of

eternalism; to say it is other-caused falls into the extreme of annihilationism. Avoiding both extremes, the Tathāgata teaches the middle way through dependent origination.]

Sūtra 301 (Right View: Kātyāyana)

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in a deep forest guest house at the town of Naḍika.

The Venerable Kātyāyana came to the Buddha and asked: ”Blessed One, what is right view? How does the Blessed One establish right view?”

The Buddha said: ”The world has two dependencies: on existence and on non-existence. Grasped by these, one either depends on existence or depends on non-existence. If there is no grasping, and the mind is not bound by attachment, not taking up 'I am,' then when suffering arises, it arises, and when suffering ceases, it ceases. Regarding this, one has no doubt, no confusion, and one knows independently of others. This is called right view.

”Why is this? One who rightly sees the arising of the world as it truly is does not conceive of the non-existence of the world. One who rightly sees the cessation of the world as it truly is does not conceive of the existence of the world. This is what it means to be free from both extremes and to teach the middle way: 'This being, that exists; with the arising of this, that arises. Conditioned by ignorance, there are formations,' and so on until the whole mass of suffering arises. 'With the cessation of ignorance, formations cease,' and so on until the whole mass of suffering ceases.”

When the Blessed One had spoken, the Venerable Kātyāyana's mind was freed from defilements without further clinging, and he attained *arhatship*.

Sūtra 302 (The Conversion of Acela Kassapa)

[Acela Kassapa meets the Buddha on the road and asks whether suffering is self-caused, other-caused, both, or neither. The Buddha says all four are ”undeclared.” Kassapa asks whether there is suffering at all. The Buddha says there is, and teaches dependent origination as the middle way. Kassapa attains the Dharma eye and takes refuge. Shortly after departing, Kassapa is killed by a protective cow, but his faculties at death are serene, his complexion bright. The Buddha confirms that Kassapa had attained the fruit and entered *nirvāṇa*.]

Sūtra 303

[The same teaching is given to the wanderer Timbaruka, who also attains the first fruit.]

Fascicle 13

Sūtras 304--364 (The Six Sixes and Sense Base Teachings)

Sūtra 304 (The Six Sixes)

[The Buddha teaches the ”six sixes” (*ṣaṭṣaṭka*): six internal sense bases, six external sense bases, six consciousnesses, six contacts, six feelings, and six cravings. He demonstrates that none of these is self, since each is subject to arising and ceasing.]

Sūtra 305 (The Analysis of the Six Sense Bases)

[A comprehensive sūtra in which the Buddha teaches how not knowing the sense bases leads to attachment, suffering, and the whole mass of suffering, while truly knowing the sense bases leads to non-attachment, the complete path (the Noble Eightfold Path, the four foundations of mindfulness, the four right efforts, the four bases of spiritual power, the five faculties, the five powers, and the seven factors of awakening), and ultimately to *nirvāṇa*.]

Sūtras 306--307 (Seeing the Dharma)

[A *bhikṣu* asks how one should know and see in order to ”see the Dharma.” The Buddha teaches through the arising of the six sense bases: eye and form give rise to eye-consciousness; these three meeting is contact; together with contact arise feeling, perception, and volition. All of these are impermanent, conditioned, and dependently arisen. If one sees their cessation, the complete extinction of craving, that is the peace of *nirvāṇa*. Sūtra 307 includes a verse summary.]

Sūtra 308

[The Buddha teaches that gods and humans, attached to the six sense objects, suffer when those objects change and cease. The Tathāgata, having truly known the arising, ceasing, gratification, danger, and escape regarding the sense objects, dwells in peace when they change and cease. He speaks in verse:]

> Regarding forms, sounds, scents, tastes, Touches, and dharmas, the six objects, If one one-sidedly generates delight And is deeply attached with craving, Then gods and humans take this alone as happiness; When it changes and ceases, they suffer greatly.
>
> Only the noble ones see the cessation as happiness; What the world regards as happiness, they regard as an enemy. What the noble ones see as suffering, the world regards as happiness; What the world regards as suffering, the noble ones regard as happiness.
>
> This profoundly difficult Dharma Gives rise to doubt and confusion in the world, Shrouded in great darkness, blind and without sight. Only the wise penetrate this darkness, Opening up the great illumination. Such a profound teaching, Who but the noble ones could know it?

Sūtra 309 (Dwelling Alone and Dwelling with a Companion)

[The Buddha teaches the Venerable Mṛgaśīrṣa (Deer-Head) about ”dwelling with a second” (*dvitīyavihāra*) and ”dwelling alone” (*ekavihāra*). If a *bhikṣu* sees a pleasant form and becomes delighted, attached, and bound, this is ”dwelling with a second,” even in a secluded forest. If a *bhikṣu* sees a pleasant form without becoming delighted, attached, or bound, this is ”dwelling alone,” even in a palace surrounded by people.]

Sūtras 310--312 (The Pūrṇa Sūtra)

[Sūtra 310: The teaching to Mṛgaśīrṣa on how joy leads to suffering and non-attachment leads to the cessation of suffering, through the six sense bases.

Sūtra 311 (Pūrṇa): The Venerable Pūrṇa asks for a brief teaching. The Buddha teaches that attachment to pleasant sense objects leads away from *nirvāṇa*, while non-attachment leads toward it. Pūrṇa then asks to go to the western land of Śroṇāparānta to teach. The Buddha warns that the people there are fierce, violent, and abusive. Through a series of questions, the Buddha tests Pūrṇa's resolve: ”What if they abuse you?” ”I will think them kind for not striking me.” ”What if they strike you?” ”I will think them kind for not using

weapons." "What if they use weapons?" "I will think them kind for not killing me." "What if they kill you?" "There are disciples of the Blessed One who, weary of their bodies, take their own lives. The people of Śroṇāparānta would kindly release me from this decaying body." The Buddha says: "Excellent, Pūrṇa! You are well trained in patience. Go now, and liberate those not yet liberated, bring peace to those not yet at peace, and grant *nirvāṇa* to those who have not yet attained it." Pūrṇa goes, establishes five hundred lay followers, builds five hundred monasteries, and within three months attains the three knowledges and enters final *nirvāṇa*.

Sūtra 312 (Māluṅkyāputta): The elderly Māluṅkyāputta asks for a brief teaching. The Buddha questions whether he has desire for forms never before seen; he does not. The Buddha teaches: "In the seen, let there be just the seen; in the heard, just the heard; in the sensed, just the sensed; in the known, just the known." Māluṅkyāputta then elaborates this teaching in verse and attains *arhatship*.]

Sūtras 313--364

[These sūtras continue the *āyatana* section with further systematic teachings on the impermanence, suffering, and not-self of the six sense bases. They include sets on cutting off desire, on birth and death, and on the various characteristics of the sense bases. Many follow the formulaic pattern established earlier.]

Fascicles 14--15

Sūtras 365--406

[These fascicles continue the dependent origination section and transitional teachings. They include teachings on the causes of suffering, the twelve links of dependent origination, and the relationship between dependent origination and the Noble Truths.]

Fascicle 15 (continued) and Fascicle 16

Sūtras 407--455 (The Four Noble Truths and Elements)

This section begins the systematic teaching on the Four Noble Truths (*catvāri āryasatyāni*) and the elements (*dhātu*).

Sūtras 407--427 (The Four Noble Truths)

[These sūtras teach the importance of understanding the Four Noble Truths through various similes and instructions:

- The *bhikṣu* should practice meditation and cultivate concentration in order to truly see the Four Noble Truths.
- Sūtra 430: The simile of the stick thrown into the air: just as a stick tossed into space must land on one end or another, so a *śramaṇa* or *brāhmaṇa* who does not truly know the Four Noble Truths will fall into the lower realms.
- Sūtra 432: The simile of the five-spoked wheel: like a wheel rapidly spinning, those who do not know the Four Noble Truths spin through the five destinies of rebirth.
- Sūtra 435: Householder Sudatta (*Anāthapiṇḍada*) asks whether the Four Noble Truths are understood gradually or all at once. The Buddha says gradually, using the simile of two thin tree-leaves joined to

hold water (impossible) versus a lotus leaf (possible), and the simile of four stairs to a palace (one must climb them in order).

- Sūtra 438: The simile of the ocean: just as one cannot skewer all the creatures in the sea with blades of grass, the beings in the universe are countless; therefore one should strive to understand the Four Noble Truths.
- Sūtra 439: The simile of the handful of earth versus the great Himalaya: those who truly know the Four Noble Truths are as few as the earth in the Buddha's hand compared to the earth of the Himalayas.
- Sūtra 440: The simile of the great lake: the suffering already ended by a noble disciple who has attained the fruit is like a great lake; the remaining suffering is like a few drops of water.
- Sūtra 442: The simile of the fingernail of earth: those who hold the five precepts, the eight precepts, or the ten wholesome actions are as few as the earth on a fingernail compared to the great earth.]

Sūtras 443--455 (The Elements)

[These sūtras transition to teachings on the various elements (*dhātu*): - Sūtra 444: The eighteen elements (six sense organs, six objects, six consciousnesses). - Sūtras 445--450: ”Beings associate with their kind”: those with unwholesome minds associate with unwholesome elements; those with wholesome minds associate with wholesome elements. Sūtra 447 illustrates this with named examples: Kauṇḍinya associates with senior monks; Mahākāśyapa with austere practitioners; Śāriputra with the wise; Mahāmaudgalyāyana with those of great psychic powers; Ānanda with the learned; Devadatta with those who practice evil. - Sūtras 451--454: Dependent origination through the eighteen elements: from elements arise contacts, from contacts arise feelings, from feelings arise cravings, and so on. The sequence is unidirectional: it is not that craving generates feeling, but feeling generates craving.]

Fascicle 17

Sūtras 456--489

[This fascicle continues with the element teachings and transitions into the sections on the factors of the path.]

Sūtra 456

[The Buddha teaches the various meditative realms: the element of light, the element of purity, the realm of infinite space, the realm of infinite consciousness, the realm of nothingness, the realm of neither perception nor non-perception, and the element of cessation. Each is known through its opposite or condition.]

Sūtras 457--489

[These sūtras include teachings on: - How lower, middle, and superior elements give rise to corresponding speech, views, and actions. - The origin of desire, ill will, and harm through their respective elements. - The eighteen elements and their role in dependent origination. - The *dhātu* (elements) related to the wholesome and unwholesome qualities of mind.]

Fascicle 18

Sūtras 490--503

[This fascicle contains the dialogues between Śāriputra and Jambukhādaka (the wanderer Jambu-Cart), and

additional teachings by Śāriputra.]

Sūtras 490 (The Jambukhādaka Dialogues)

[Jambukhādaka asks Śāriputra a series of questions: ”What is *nirvāṇa*? What is the path to *nirvāṇa*? What is the *arhat*? What is suffering? What is the world? What is the raft? What is respite? What is supreme respite? What is cooling? What is supreme cooling? What is craving? What are the unwholesome courses of action? What are the defilements?” To each, Śāriputra gives a brief doctrinal answer and states that the path is the Noble Eightfold Path. These dialogues are each concluded with the formulaic phrase ”The two worthy ones discussed and then each departed.”]

Sūtra 491

[As the Jambukhādaka dialogues, so also a renunciant's questions, explained in the same way.]

Sūtra 492 (Śāriputra on Meditation and Nirvāṇa)

[Śāriputra teaches that a *bhikṣu* who attains boundless *samādhi* but whose mind does not delight in the cessation of existence is like a man whose hand is sticky with glue grasping a tree branch. He cannot let go. But a *bhikṣu* whose mind delights in the cessation of existence is like one whose hand is clean. Therefore, one should strive to break through ignorance.]

Sūtra 493 (Śāriputra on Testing for Liberation from Desire)

[Śāriputra teaches the test for liberation from sensual desire: if a *bhikṣu* contemplates a beautiful object and desire arises, he is like a man rowing a boat upstream who, upon resting, drifts back downstream. If desire does not arise, he is like a feather that curls when placed in fire and cannot be spread out again.]

Sūtras 494--495

[Śāriputra teaches on the supernatural powers of meditation (the ability to transform elements through concentration) and on the relationship between virtue and liberation (virtue as the root, like the roots of a tree that make fruit possible).]

Sūtras 496--497 (On Reproving Monks)

[Detailed teachings on how to properly reprove fellow monks: the reprover should speak with truth, at the right time, with beneficial intent, gently, and with compassion. The one reproved should also examine himself. Five conditions for properly reproving, five conditions for being properly reproved, and the proper attitude of both parties are fully explained.]

Sūtra 498 (Śāriputra's Lion's Roar)

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Nālandā in Pāvārika's Mango Grove.

Śāriputra came to the Buddha and said: ”Blessed One, I have deep faith that among all *śramaṇas* and *brāhmaṇas* of the past, future, and present, none has wisdom equal to the Blessed One's perfect awakening, let alone surpassing it.”

The Buddha said: ”Excellent, Śāriputra! Do you know the minds of all the Buddhas of the past?”

”No, Blessed One.”

”Do you know the minds of all the Buddhas of the future? The present?”

”No, Blessed One.”

”Then on what basis do you make this declaration?”

Śāriputra said: ”Blessed One, I do not know the minds of the Buddhas, but I know the Dharma's pattern. Just as a king has a border fortress with only one gate, and the gatekeeper, though not knowing the exact number of people entering and leaving, knows that everyone passes through that one gate, so too I know this: all the Buddhas of the past, future, and present have abandoned the five hindrances, established themselves in the four foundations of mindfulness, cultivated the seven factors of awakening, and attained *anuttarā-samyak-saṃbodhi*.”

The Buddha said: ”Just so, Śāriputra.”

Sūtras 499--503

[Sūtra 499: Śāriputra's dialogue with Candraputra, a disciple of Devadatta, on the difference between mere mental cultivation and genuine liberation.

Sūtra 500: Śāriputra and the wanderer Pure-Mouth (*Śuddhikā*), who asks about the four kinds of wrong livelihood (downward eating, upward eating, sideways eating, and diagonal eating). Śāriputra explains these as fortune-telling, astrology, acting as messenger, and medical practice for gain, respectively, and declares that he lives by pure livelihood.

Sūtras 501--503: Mahāmaudgalyāyana's accounts of being guided by the Buddha in meditation, including the Buddha's instruction on ”noble silence” (the second *dhyāna*) and the ”noble dwelling” (the signless *samādhi*).]

Fascicle 19

Sūtras 504--536

[This fascicle contains Mahāmaudgalyāyana's encounters with Śakra (Indra) and the gods of the Thirty-Three Heaven, and the Buddha's descent from heaven.]

Sūtra 504 (Śakra and Generosity)

[Śakra visits Maudgalyāyana and speaks a verse praising the merit of generosity. Maudgalyāyana asks what fruit Śakra has seen. Śakra describes his great palace Vaijayanta with its hundred and one pavilions.]

Sūtra 505 (Maudgalyāyana Shakes the Palace)

[Maudgalyāyana visits the Thirty-Three Heaven and finds Śakra distracted by celestial pleasures. To rouse him from complacency, Maudgalyāyana enters *samādhi* and with his great toe shakes the entire palace. The celestial maidens are terrified. When told this is not their lord's teacher but merely a fellow disciple, they exclaim: ”How powerful must the teacher himself be!”]

Sūtra 506 (The Buddha's Descent from Heaven)

[The Buddha spends the summer retreat in the Thirty-Three Heaven, teaching the Dharma to his mother and the gods. Maudgalyāyana, at the request of the fourfold assembly, travels to heaven and conveys their wish for the Buddha to return. The Buddha instructs that in seven days he will descend at the city of Saṃkāśya under an *udumbara* tree. On the appointed day, the Buddha descends, accompanied by gods, *nāgas*, and spirits, and the Brahma gods. That occasion becomes known as ”the place of the descent from heaven.”]

Sūtras 507--536

[Additional sūtras in this section include Maudgalyāyana's dialogues with various gods, teachings on the fruits of merit and the factors of stream-entry, and further accounts of celestial encounters.]

Fascicles 20--24

Sūtras 537--639

[These fascicles cover a range of topics:

- **The Faculties and Powers** (*indriya* and *bala*): Systematic teachings on the five faculties (faith, effort, mindfulness, concentration, wisdom) and five powers, and how they lead to the various stages of awakening.
- **The Factors of Awakening** (*bodhyaṅga*): Teachings on the seven factors of awakening (mindfulness, investigation of dharmas, effort, joy, tranquility, concentration, equanimity).
- **The Noble Eightfold Path**: Extensive teachings on right view, right intention, right speech, right action, right livelihood, right effort, right mindfulness, and right concentration.
- **The Four Foundations of Mindfulness** (*smṛtyupasthāna*): Detailed instructions on contemplating body, feelings, mind, and dharmas.
- **The Four Right Efforts** and **Four Bases of Spiritual Power**: Teachings on generating and maintaining wholesome states and on the foundations of psychic ability.
- **Stream-entry** and the **four fruits**: Teachings on the factors leading to stream-entry (*srotāpatti*), once-returning (*sakṛdāgāmin*), non-returning (*anāgāmin*), and *arhatship*.
- **Lay practice**: Teachings to householders on the four factors of stream-entry (faith in the Buddha, Dharma, and Saṅgha, and moral conduct).]

Fascicle 25

Sūtras 640--641 (The Aśoka Narrative)

Sūtra 640

[This sūtra contains the prophecy of Aśoka. The Buddha, during a previous life as a child, offered a handful of dirt (as play-food) to a former Buddha. Due to that merit, he was reborn as the great King Aśoka, who would honor the Buddha's relics by distributing them among 84,000 stūpas. This is an unusual narrative passage within the *āgama*.]

Sūtra 641

[Continuation of the Aśoka narrative, including the story of King Aśoka's final offering of half an *āmalaka* fruit, his only remaining possession as he lay dying. The ministers accept this final gift and honor it by placing it in the monks' meal as an offering to the Saṅgha.]

Fascicles 26--27

Sūtras 642--747 (The Seven Factors of Awakening)

[These fascicles contain extensive teachings on the seven factors of awakening:]

Sūtra 717

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Anāthapiṇḍada's Park in Jeta's Grove in Śrāvastī.

At that time, the Blessed One addressed the *bhikṣus*: ”In external dharmas, I do not see a single dharma that causes unarisen unwholesome states to arise, and arisen unwholesome states to increase and grow, and unarisen wholesome states not to arise, and arisen wholesome states to decline, as does bad friendship and bad companionship. Bad friendship and bad companionship cause the unarisen hindrance of sensual desire to arise, and the arisen one to increase. The same for the hindrances of ill will, sloth and torpor, restlessness and remorse, and doubt. It causes the unarisen mindfulness factor of awakening not to arise, and the arisen one to decline. The same for investigation of dharmas, effort, joy, tranquility, concentration, and equanimity.

”*Bhikṣus*, I do not see a single dharma that prevents unarisen unwholesome states from arising, that causes arisen ones to cease, that causes unarisen wholesome states to arise, and arisen wholesome states to increase and grow, as does good friendship and good companionship. Good friendship and good companionship prevent the unarisen hindrance of sensual desire from arising and cause the arisen one to cease. [The same for all five hindrances and all seven factors of awakening.]”

When the *bhikṣus* heard the Buddha's words, they rejoiced and put them into practice.

Sūtra 726 (Good Friendship Is the Whole of the Holy Life)

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling at the Cleft Rock in Rājagṛha. The Venerable Ānanda was also there.

Ānanda, in solitary meditation, thought: ”Half of the holy life consists of good friendship, good companionship, and good association.”

He went to the Buddha and reported this thought. The Buddha said: ”Do not say this, Ānanda. Do not say that half of the holy life is good friendship. Why? Because the whole of the holy life, complete and pure, consists of good friendship, good companionship, and good association. Because I am a good friend, beings who take up the mindfulness factor of awakening from me do so based on seclusion, based on dispassion, based on cessation, inclining toward relinquishment. The same for investigation of dharmas, effort, joy, tranquility, concentration, and equanimity. Therefore, Ānanda, know this: the whole of the holy life consists of good friendship.”

When the *bhikṣus* heard the Buddha's words, they rejoiced and put them into practice.

Sūtra 727 (Ānanda Recites the Seven Factors of Awakening)

[When the Buddha is ill near Kuśinagara, lying on his folded outer robe, he asks Ānanda to recite the seven factors of awakening. Ānanda does so. The Buddha then asks: ”Did you speak of effort?” Ānanda confirms. The Buddha says: ”Only through effort, cultivated and developed, does one attain *anuttarā-samyak-saṃbodhi*.” Upon saying this, the Buddha sits upright in mindfulness. A *bhikṣu* present speaks a verse praising the power of hearing the Dharma.]

Sūtras 728--747

[Additional sūtras on the factors of awakening, including: - The seven treasures of a wheel-turning monarch as parallels to the seven factors of awakening. - How the factors of awakening lead to two fruits (either the ending of defilements in this life or the fruit of non-return), or four fruits (stream-entry through *arhatship*), or seven fruits (including the five types of *anāgāmin*: those who attain *nirvāṇa* midway, at birth, with effort, without effort, or by going upstream). - The factors of awakening combined with contemplation of impurity, mindfulness of death, the four *brahmavihāras* (loving-kindness, compassion, sympathetic joy, equanimity), the formless attainments, and *ānāpānasmṛti* (mindfulness of breathing). - Sūtra 743: The Buddha teaches that his cultivation of loving-kindness (*maitrī*) combined with the factors of awakening differs from that of non-Buddhist teachers, because it leads to the four *brahmavihāras* being connected to the formless attainments: loving-kindness to purity, compassion to infinite space, joy to infinite consciousness, equanimity to nothingness.]

Fascicle 28

Sūtras 748--784 (The Noble Eightfold Path)

Sūtra 748

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Anāthapiṇḍada's Park in Jeta's Grove in Śrāvastī.

At that time, the Blessed One addressed the *bhikṣus*: ”Just as the dawn, the first light before sunrise, is the precursor of the sun's rising, so too the precursor of a *bhikṣu*'s completely ending suffering is right view. From right view arise right intention, right speech, right action, right livelihood, right effort, right mindfulness, and right concentration. From right concentration arises right liberation. The noble disciple's mind is rightly freed from desire, ill will, and delusion. With the mind well freed, the noble disciple gains right knowledge: 'My birth is ended, the holy life has been lived, what was to be done has been done, I know that there will be no further existence.'”

When the *bhikṣus* heard the Buddha's words, they rejoiced and put them into practice.

Sūtra 749

[The precursor of all unwholesome states is ignorance (*avidyā*), which gives rise to lack of conscience and lack of moral shame, which lead to wrong view, wrong intention, and so forth. The precursor of all wholesome states is knowledge (*vidyā*), which gives rise to conscience and moral shame, which lead to right view, right intention, and so forth.]

Sūtra 750

[All unwholesome states have ignorance as their root; all wholesome states have knowledge as their root. Full explanation of the content of ignorance and knowledge, followed by the arising of the complete eightfold path.]

Sūtras 751--784

[These sūtras continue with teachings on the Noble Eightfold Path, including: - On right and wrong endeavors for householders and renunciants. - The definition of desire (*kāma*) as not the objects themselves but the craving for them. - The relationship between the eightfold path and the four noble truths. - How the eightfold path leads to the ending of various defilements. - The distinction between the worldly and noble eightfold paths.]

Fascicles 29--35

Sūtras 785--1005

[These fascicles contain diverse teachings:]

Fascicles 29--31 (Sūtras 785--860): Further teachings on meditation practices, the *dhyānas*, the formless attainments, and mindfulness of breathing (*ānāpānasmṛti*). Key sūtras include detailed instructions on the sixteen stages of mindfulness of breathing and how this practice fulfills the four foundations of mindfulness, which in turn fulfill the seven factors of awakening, which fulfill knowledge and liberation.

Fascicle 32 (Sūtras 861--904): The *Saṃyutta* on stream-entry (*srotāpatti*), teaching the four factors of stream-entry: verified faith in the Buddha, verified faith in the Dharma, verified faith in the Saṅgha, and virtues dear to the noble ones.

Fascicle 33 (Sūtras 905--937): Teachings on food, effort, and various aspects of practice.

Fascicles 34--35 (Sūtras 938--1005): Miscellaneous dialogues and teachings, including dialogues with the wanderer Vacchagotta and various laypeople.

Fascicle 35 (continued) and Fascicle 36

Sūtras 1006--1022 (Heavenly Beings)

[This section contains sūtras in which *devas* (heavenly beings) visit the Buddha at night, their radiance illuminating Jeta's Grove, and ask questions in verse. The Buddha answers in verse. Each concludes with the *deva* praising the Buddha:]

> Long have I seen the *brāhmaṇa* Who has attained *nirvāṇa*. All fears he has passed beyond,
> Forever transcending the world's attachments.

[Topics of the verse dialogues include: - What constitutes the non-path? (Craving.) - What passes day and night? (Life.) - What is the stain of the holy life? (Women.) - What dominates the world? (Names.) - What is the cause of verse? (Desire.) - How does one know a chariot, a fire, a kingdom, a wife?]

Fascicle 37

Sūtras 1023--1038 (Visiting the Sick)

[This section contains a series of sūtras about visiting and teaching the sick:]

Sūtra 1023

[The Venerable Phagguṇa is gravely ill. The Buddha visits him, teaches him, and Phagguṇa dies peacefully. The Buddha explains the six cases of benefiting through hearing the Dharma at the time of illness, and declares Phagguṇa a non-returner.]

Sūtra 1024 (Aśvajit)

[The Venerable Aśvajit is gravely ill and regrets the loss of his *samādhi*. The Buddha teaches him that even without attaining deep concentration, if one sees the five aggregates as not-self and abandons greed, hatred, and delusion, one attains liberation.]

Sūtra 1025

[A young, newly ordained *bhikṣu* is gravely ill, alone and without attendants. The Buddha visits him, teaches him through the six sense bases (what arises dependently will also cease), and the *bhikṣu* dies peacefully, his faculties serene. The Buddha declares him to have attained *nirvāṇa* and receives the first prediction of his liberation.]

Sūtra 1030 (Anāthapiṇḍada)

[The householder Anāthapiṇḍada falls ill. The Buddha visits him and teaches the four factors of stream-entry. Anāthapiṇḍada confirms he possesses them all, and the Buddha declares him a non-returner.]

Sūtra 1031

[Ānanda visits the sick Anāthapiṇḍada, who tells him not to fear: ”From the time I first saw the Blessed One at the Cool Grove in Rājagṛha, I have possessed unshakable faith in the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha, and noble virtue.” Ānanda declares him a stream-enterer.]

Sūtra 1032 (Śāriputra's Deep Teaching to Anāthapiṇḍada)

[Śāriputra and Ānanda visit the sick Anāthapiṇḍada. Śāriputra teaches him not to cling to any of the six sense bases, the six objects, the six consciousnesses, the six contacts, the six feelings, the four elements, the five aggregates. Anāthapiṇḍada weeps. Ānanda asks if he is frightened. He says: ”No, but in twenty years of devotion to the Blessed One, I have never heard such a deep teaching from the Venerable Śāriputra.” Śāriputra admits he has never taught laypeople this way before. Anāthapiṇḍada says: ”There are lay devotees with great faith who would benefit from hearing such deep teachings. Please, Venerable Śāriputra, teach the laity the deep Dharma out of compassion.”]

Sūtras 1033--1038

[Additional sūtras on visiting the sick and teaching the four factors of stream-entry, the six recollections, and the six marks of clear knowledge. Various laypeople are declared stream-enterers, once-returners, or

non-returners.]

Fascicles 38--42

Sūtras 1039--1144

[These fascicles contain miscellaneous teachings:]

Fascicle 38 (Sūtras 1039--1061): Teachings to Mahānāma the Sakyan on the qualities of a lay disciple, the recollections, and the practice of generosity.

Fascicle 39 (Sūtras 1062--1079): Teachings on the wheel-turning monarch and the ideal ruler, teachings on cosmology.

Fascicle 40 (Sūtras 1080--1103): Further miscellaneous teachings.

Fascicle 41 (Sūtras 1104--1120): Teachings on various topics including the arising of the *saṃgha*, rules of conduct, and teachings to laypeople.

Fascicle 42 (Sūtras 1121--1144): Encounters with Māra, including Māra's attempts to frighten the *bhikṣus* and the *bhikṣuṇīs*, and their courageous responses.

Fascicles 43--46

Sūtras 1145--1240

[These fascicles contain additional thematic collections:]

Fascicle 43 (Sūtras 1145--1163): The *Vaṅgīsa* section: verses by the Venerable Vaṅgīsa, a poet among the disciples, on various occasions.

Fascicle 44 (Sūtras 1164--1177): Dialogues with *brāhmaṇas* and wanderers.

Fascicle 45 (Sūtras 1178--1197): Further teachings to *brāhmaṇas*, including teachings on the true *brāhmaṇa*, on fire sacrifice, and on the correct understanding of caste.

Fascicle 46 (Sūtras 1198--1240): The King Pasenadi section: dialogues between the Buddha and King Pasenadi of Kosala on various topics including governance, merit, the Buddha's age, and the nature of human conduct.

Sūtra 1226

[King Pasenadi arrives at the Buddha's dwelling, having just come from dealing with state affairs. The Buddha teaches him on various matters of governance, virtue, and the impermanence of worldly power.]

Sūtras 1232--1233 (Mahānāma the Miser)

[The story of the wealthy but miserly Mahānāma, who hoards his fortune but lives in poverty. After his death without heirs, his wealth is confiscated by the king. The Buddha teaches that wealth used for generosity and merit leads to lasting benefit, while wealth hoarded out of miserliness is like a pool in a desolate place that dries up, benefiting no one.]

Fascicles 47--50

Sūtras 1241--1362 (Forest-Dwelling Devas)

[The final four fascicles contain a beautiful collection of sūtras about *bhikṣus* dwelling in forests and their encounters with tree-dwelling *devas* (spirits) who offer encouragement, admonition, or poetic inspiration.]

Sūtra 1341

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Anāthapiṇḍada's Park in Jeta's Grove in Śrāvastī.

There was a *bhikṣu* dwelling in a forest in the Kosalan countryside. He was attached only to maintaining his precepts but did not strive to advance in higher spiritual attainments.

The *deva* dwelling in that forest thought: ”This is not the proper conduct of a *bhikṣu*. He dwells in the forest attached only to keeping precepts, without cultivating higher attainments. I should find a way to rouse him.” The *deva* spoke in verse:

> Not by holding to precepts alone, Nor by study and learning, Nor by solitary meditation and *samādhi*, Nor by dwelling apart in seclusion,
>
> Should a *bhikṣu* rest content, For never thus are defilements ended. The joy of the Perfectly Awakened One Is far beyond the reach of ordinary beings.

The *bhikṣu*, roused by the *deva*'s exhortation, practiced diligently, cut off the defilements, and attained *arhat-ship*.

Sūtra 1342

[A *deva* admonishes a *bhikṣu* named Nāgadatta who socializes too much with laypeople: ”Going out early, returning late, associating with monastics and laypeople alike, sharing their joys and sorrows, I fear the arising of heedlessness under Māra's power.”]

Sūtra 1343

[A *deva* admonishes a group of *bhikṣus* who talk, joke, and let their minds wander all day, comparing them unfavorably to the disciples of old who begged for alms mindfully and contemplated impermanence.]

Sūtra 1344

[A *bhikṣu* falsely accused of impropriety with a laywoman contemplates suicide. A *deva* transforms into the woman's form and tests his resolve, then reveals itself and teaches in verse:]

> Though hearing many evil rumors, The practitioner of austerity endures them. One should not torment oneself, Nor should one become agitated.
>
> One who fears mere sounds Is like a beast in the forest, A frivolous being Who does not fulfill the renunciant life.
>
> One should patiently endure And not dwell amid evil words. A steadfast and resolute one Fulfills the renunciant life.

> Others' words do not make you a bandit, Nor do others' words make you an *arhat*. As you yourself know, So too do the gods know.

The *bhikṣu*, roused, practiced diligently and attained *arhatship*.

Sūtra 1345

[A *deva* praises the Venerable Vidyāmitra (one who wears rag-robes), before whom seven hundred Brahma gods have come to pay respects. The *deva* speaks in verse:]

> Observe him, senses stilled, Who attracts such offerings! Endowed with the three knowledges, Having attained the unshakeable Dharma, Having crossed all expedients, Wearing rag-robes with few possessions, Seven hundred Brahma gods Come in their palaces to honor him. He has seen the end of birth and death; Now they honor one who has crossed to the other shore.

Sūtra 1346 (The Sleepy Bhikṣu)

[A *deva* rouses a sleepy *bhikṣu* with verses. The *bhikṣu* protests his weakness, and the *deva* urges him on. The *bhikṣu* promises to follow the *deva*'s advice and practices diligently for seven nights, attaining *arhatship*. The *deva* then reveals that fourteen stream-enterers had previously dwelt in that forest, and the *deva* had roused the *bhikṣu* because he alone was still heedless. The *bhikṣu* thanks the *deva*, who promises to care for him if he falls ill.]

Sūtras 1347--1355

[Further forest sūtras: - Sūtra 1347: Śāriputra encounters a drunken *nirgrantha* (Jain ascetic) who speaks a verse about how liquor makes everything appear golden. Śāriputra responds with a verse about how the signless *samādhi* makes everything appear as worthless as spittle. - Sūtra 1349: A *deva* contemplates the Buddha's footprints, and when a bird (*ulūka*) threatens to step on them, the *deva* speaks a verse protecting the footprints. - Sūtra 1350: A *deva* praises the wind that blows *pāṭali* flowers upon the Tathāgata. - Sūtra 1351: A mountain *deva* praises the *bhikṣus* of Cetiya Mountain with three verses about the peacock's cry awakening the alms-gathering, rag-robe-wearing, tree-dwelling monks. - Sūtra 1352: Three *bhikṣus* on Cetiya Mountain are killed by a collapsing riverbank. A *deva* warns other forest-dwelling *bhikṣus* not to engage in building projects. - Sūtra 1353: A forest fire on Mount Vindhya inspires a *bhikṣu* to reflect: ”All conditioned things are blazing; the wise can extinguish them.” - Sūtra 1354: A woman about to drown herself in the Ganges due to her mother-in-law's cruelty inspires a *bhikṣu* to reflect: ”With faith, I shall flow along the noble eightfold stream into *nirvāṇa*, free from Māra's power.” - Sūtra 1355: A thief stealing melons says: ”Moon, do not come out until I have cut these melons.” A *bhikṣu* responds: ”Evil Māra, do not come out until I have cut these defilements.”]

Sūtra 1356

[A novice asks riddles: ”What is permanent? Begging for alms is permanent. What is impermanent? Monastery food is impermanent. What is straight? Indra's banner. What is crooked? A hook.” A *bhikṣu* gives the correct Dharma answers: ”What is permanent? Only *nirvāṇa*. What is impermanent? All conditioned things. What is straight? The Noble Eightfold Path. What is crooked? Only the evil path.”]

Sūtra 1357

[Śāriputra asks a potter for a bowl for his sick disciple. When the potter asks for a teaching in exchange,

Śāriputra teaches about giving that costs nothing: giving meat to one who does not eat meat, giving women to a celibate, giving high beds to one who sits on the ground, giving a resting place to a traveler.]

Sūtra 1359

[A *deva* transforms into a dancing skeleton before a *bhikṣu* who was daydreaming about obtaining fine cloth. Terrified, the *bhikṣu* abandons his material desires and attains *arhatship*.]

Sūtra 1360

[An *arhat* hears a woman's lament on a dark rainy night as she falls into the mud, losing her ornaments on her way to a tryst. He responds in verse: ”The defilements are completely destroyed; I have crossed the mire of birth and death; the bonds and attachments are all scattered. The Honored One of the ten directions beholds me.”]

Sūtra 1361

[A man crossing a river with his wife plays the lute and sings of worldly pleasure. A *bhikṣu* responds: ”Holding the pure precepts, delighting in the Perfectly Awakened One, bathed in the three liberations, well cooled and refreshed, adorned with the path of humanity, what joy could surpass this?”]

Sūtra 1362

Thus have I heard:

At one time, the Buddha was dwelling in Anāthapiṇḍada's Park in Jeta's Grove in Śrāvastī.

There was a *bhikṣu* dwelling in a forest in the Kosalan countryside.

A *deva*, seeing pigeons, spoke in verse:

> Pigeons, you should gather Sesame, rice, and millet, And on the mountain-tops in the trees Build your lofty nests. When the rains come, You will rest in peace with food and shelter.

The *bhikṣu* thought: ”That *deva* is also awakening me!” He spoke in verse:

> Ordinary people should gather wholesome dharmas, Paying reverence to the Three Jewels. When the body breaks up and life ends, Their spirit will rest in peace and happiness.

The *bhikṣu*, having spoken this verse and been thus awakened, practiced diligently, cut off the defilements, and attained *arhatship*.

Fascicle 50

[End of text.]